CASE STUDY 02

SERVICE DESK TICKETING & TIER 2 ESCALATION

Microsoft 365 sign-in interruption following an MFA device replacement

PLATFORM

Jira Service Management

SCENARIO TYPE

Fictional access incident

WORKFLOW

Tier 1 triage → Tier 2 identity escalation

DOCUMENT STATUS / NOVEMBER 2026

Guided simulation and sample documentation. No new Jira ticket, real escalation, specialist intervention, or access restoration is claimed as completed.

Prepared for a hands-on portfolio exercise. The sample ticket ID SIM-002 is a case-study label, not a Jira-issued work-item key.

01 / INTAKE / CASE 02

Incident overview

A distinct scenario from the HDL-1 Wi-Fi lab: access recovery and escalation rather than network connectivity troubleshooting.

FICTIONAL REQUEST - CUSTOMER STATEMENT

"I replaced my phone and can no longer approve the sign-in prompt for my work Microsoft 365 account. I cannot access Outlook or Teams."

Proposed ticket metadata

Portfolio scenario ID	SIM-002 (illustrative; not a Jira-generated issue key)
Request type	Incident / IT help request - use the type available in your Jira project
Affected user	Employee A - fictional; no real account identifiers
Business impact	One employee unable to access Outlook and Teams
Priority	Suggested P3 / moderate; confirm with local impact and urgency policy
Support ownership	Tier 1 Service Desk → Identity & Access / Tier 2 specialist
Current evidence	Scenario designed; execution and live Jira screenshots pending

What the service desk needs to learn

- Exact sign-in message, error code, timestamp, and which Microsoft 365 apps are affected.
- Whether the employee has an approved backup sign-in method and can reach trusted self-service options.
- Whether other staff report the same issue; check for a wider service interruption before assigning priority.
- Which organization-approved identity verification route applies before recovery is attempted.

02 / TRIAGE / CASE 02

Tier 1 diagnostic plan

Practice safe, reproducible triage. Avoid privileged recovery actions at the first-line service desk.

1. Acknowledge and classify — Record the requested service, single-user impact, urgency, and the specific sign-in symptom.
2. Check scope — Ask whether other users are affected; if access exists, review the official Microsoft 365 service-health channel.
3. Collect safe diagnostics — Capture the error text, approximate timestamp/time zone, app and browser, and the last known successful sign-in.
4. Check approved alternatives — Ask whether a different already registered authentication method is available; do not request authentication codes.
5. Verify identity through policy — Use only the organization's approved verification or recovery procedure; never reset MFA solely on an unverified request.
6. Decide ownership — If no policy-approved self-service path is available, route to the authorized identity-access support team.

CONTROL GATE - SAFETY & ACCESS

Never request: a password, live MFA code, recovery code, authentication token, or personal ID documents through the ticket comments. Do not bypass MFA or change authentication methods without authorization and verified identity.

03 / HANDOFF / CASE 02

Escalation packet

An escalation should give the next support tier enough context to act without starting the investigation over.

Decision criteria for Tier 2 handoff

- The employee cannot use an already-registered, permitted authentication method.
- Tier 1 has confirmed the incident is not a known broad outage and has documented safe observations.
- The next action requires privileged identity administration or formal recovery approval.

SAMPLE INTERNAL ESCALATION NOTE - COPY-READY

Scenario ID: SIM-002 (fictional)
Summary: Employee replaced mobile device; Microsoft 365 sign-in blocked at MFA challenge.
Impact: One fictional user; Outlook / Teams access unavailable. Proposed P3 pending policy validation.
Tier 1 checks: Error/time captured; scope checked; approved recovery options reviewed. No credentials or MFA codes collected.
Reason for escalation: Recovery of authentication methods requires authorized identity specialist and verified identity.
Requested Tier 2 action: Validate identity through approved process, review sign-in evidence with authorized tooling, apply approved recovery route, and advise on user testing.
Pending: Assigned specialist, decision, verified customer retest, final resolution.

HANDOFF QUALITY CHECK

- Named next-owner or escalation queue (in a real simulation, record who accepts handoff).
- Priority is justified from impact and urgency, not assumed from the title.
- Notes distinguish observed evidence from assumptions and proposed actions.
- Customer gets a status update without exposing sensitive internal steps.

04 / COMMUNICATION / CASE 02

Customer & internal notes

Jira Service Management distinguishes customer-visible replies from internal notes. The following are drafts, not sent messages.

CUSTOMER REPLY - ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Thanks for reporting the Microsoft 365 sign-in problem. I understand you cannot access Outlook and Teams after replacing your phone. I am documenting the error and checking the approved recovery options. I will provide an update once the next support step is confirmed.

INTERNAL NOTE - TRIAGE

Case: SIM-002 (training scenario).
Impact: Single user; proposed P3 subject to local policy.
Known facts: Sign-in challenge follows phone replacement; no second factor available in scenario.
Action: Gather error and timestamp, assess scope, verify recovery policy, request authorized Tier 2 review.
Do not state: “MFA reset completed” without evidence.

CUSTOMER REPLY - ESCALATION UPDATE

Your request has been referred to our identity-access support team because the next recovery step requires additional authorization. Your access has not yet been restored. We will contact you through the organization’s approved channel for the required identity verification and next steps.

CONDITIONAL CLOSURE MESSAGE - USE ONLY AFTER VERIFICATION

The authorized identity-access process has been completed, and you confirmed that you can sign in to Microsoft 365 and open Outlook and Teams. We are closing the incident. If the issue returns, please reply to this request. Do not post this message until the actions and customer test are actually documented.

Visibility rule: Keep handoff details, diagnostic observations and privileged-work notes internal. Put plain-language progress updates in customer-visible replies.

05 / LIFECYCLE / CASE 02

Status, ownership & closure

An example ticket path for a supervised simulation. Real status names depend on the Jira project workflow.

01	Open / waiting for support Record intake and impact.	TIER 1
02	In progress Complete allowed triage and policy check.	TIER 1
03	Escalated / awaiting specialist Document handoff and assign authorized owner.	TIER 2
04	Pending validation Record approved specialist outcome; ask user to test.	SHARED
05	Resolved / closed Use only after real evidence supports the disposition.	TIER 1

POSSIBLE END STATES

A / VERIFIED RESTORATION

Only if the authorized recovery process is carried out and the customer confirms that sign-in works.

B / NO VERIFIED RESOLUTION

Keep the ticket pending, or document training closure as a simulation. Do not claim restored access.

For this PDF: No Jira ticket was created or transitioned, no Tier 2 agent was assigned, and no Microsoft 365 identity changes were performed. The above represents a proposed exercise.

06 / PRACTICE / CASE 02

Hands-on Jira lab checklist

Perform these actions in your own training workspace with only fictional users and non-sensitive information.

1. Create a new request — Use a suitable IT-help/incident request type. Title: “Training - Microsoft 365 sign-in after phone change”. Let Jira generate the real work-item key.
2. Populate fields — Description, impact, suggested priority (verify policy), affected service, fictional reporter, and training/simulation label if available.
3. Add the triage record — Post the sample internal note from page 5 using Add internal note, with wording adapted to the work actually performed.
4. Send a simulated customer reply — Use Reply to customer where permitted; keep it clearly labeled as a fictional training exercise.
5. Demonstrate a handoff — If no Tier 2 account is available, document a proposed escalation. Never assign a nonexistent real specialist or imply a real handoff occurred.
6. Record status and disposition — Use only statuses available in your workflow. If no recovery is performed, leave the result “not verified” and do not claim an authentic resolution.
7. Capture proof — Save redacted screenshots of the issue, request fields, internal note, customer reply, and actual status/assignee history.

JIRA UI TIP

In the Activity area, Jira Service Management typically offers Add internal note and Reply to customer. Workflow and escalation controls vary by project permissions and configuration.

07 / EVIDENCE / CASE 02

Proof checklist & placeholders

Do not present illustrated entries as screenshots. Add genuine, redacted evidence after completing the Jira exercise.

SCREENSHOT

01 / REQUEST INTAKE

Issue key, fictional title, request type, priority and description.

SCREENSHOT

02 / TIER 1 NOTE

Actual internal note containing symptom, impact and triage observations.

SCREENSHOT

03 / USER COMMUNICATION

Actual fictional customer-visible reply or a clearly labeled unsent sample.

SCREENSHOT

04 / ESCALATION EVIDENCE

Assignment, status change, or note that escalation is proposed only.

SCREENSHOT

05 / FINAL DISPOSITION

Real workflow status plus evidence-based outcome; do not claim unverified recovery.

Privacy check: Redact email addresses, tenant names, authentication details, customer-identifying information, and any sensitive system data before committing a public PDF to GitHub.

Evidence status at creation: All five slots are placeholders. No screenshot from this new SIM-002 scenario is included.

08 / PORTFOLIO USE / CASE 02

Publishing & assessment

Convert this guide into a documented case study once the new hands-on Jira exercise is completed.

SUGGESTED PORTFOLIO CARD - BEFORE EXECUTION

Title: Microsoft 365 Access Incident - Escalation Lab (Planned)
Description: Designed a Jira Service Management training scenario covering MFA-related sign-in failure, Tier 1 triage, internal documentation, safe identity verification, and proposed Tier 2 escalation.
Evidence: Guided scenario PDF; Jira screenshots and verified workflow results pending.

Completion rubric

Request quality	Accurate scenario, impact, priority rationale and clear intake.
Safety	No secrets collected; verification and authorization boundaries respected.
Handoff	Useful internal note, explicit escalation reason and next owner.
Customer care	Accessible updates, no premature recovery promises.
Evidence	Genuine screenshots and transparent disposition.

After completing the exercise

- Replace SIM-002 with the real Jira key in your final report, or keep SIM-002 clearly described as a portfolio scenario ID.
- Update the portfolio card from “Planned” to “Completed simulation” only when the actual Jira work is documented.
- Keep this distinct from Wi-Fi incident HDL-1; the skills being assessed are identity-access triage and escalation.

REFERENCE DOCUMENTATION

Atlassian Support: Customer replies vs internal notes | Escalation practices

Microsoft Learn: Entra ID account recovery overview. Availability and approved recovery methods depend on the organization.

This document is an original training artifact. It does not certify Jira actions, specialist work, or account access restoration.